Tutorial 2 – Information Driven Entrepreneurship and Enterprise

1. E-business (EB) and e-commerce (EC)

a. What is the difference between e-business and e-commerce?

Answer:
E-commerce refers specifically to the buying and selling of goods and services using electronic networks, mainly the internet. It focuses on online transactions such as ordering, payment, and delivery coordination.

E-business is a broader concept that includes e-commerce but also covers all electronically enabled business processes, such as customer relationship management, supply chain management, internal operations, and information systems. Therefore, e-commerce is a subset of e-business.

b. Two additional definitions of e-business and e-commerce

E-business definitions:

1. IBM (2020) defines e-business as the transformation of key business processes through the use of internet technologies.
2. Laudon & Laudon (2020) describe e-business as the use of digital technologies to execute business processes within the firm and with external partners.

E-commerce definitions:

1. Turban et al. (2018) define e-commerce as the process of buying, selling, or exchanging products, services, and information via computer networks.
2. OECD (2019) defines e-commerce as commercial transactions conducted over open networks such as the internet.

Reliability & comparison:
These sources are reliable academic and institutional references. The definitions support the same relationship presented in the lecture: **e-commerce is part of e-business**, not a separate or larger concept.

c. Relationship between EB and EC (figures)

Question	Answer
i. Which figure matches the lecture definitions?	The figure where **EC is inside EB**
ii. Which figure reflects found definitions?	EC as a subset of EB
iii. Which figure is realistic?	EC ⊂ EB, because businesses use digital tools beyond transactions
iv. If terms are interchangeable?	The figure where **EB = EC**

2. Classification of E-business according to forms of operation

a. Define dotcom and dotcorp businesses

Answer:

A **dotcom business** operates exclusively online and was created specifically for digital operations.

A **dotcorp business** is a traditional company that has extended its operations online as part of its business strategy.

b. Examples of dotcom and dotcorp businesses

Type	Example	Justification
Dotcom	PayPal	Entirely digital financial service
Dotcom	TradeKey	Online-only B2B marketplace
Dotcorp	Dell	Traditional manufacturer with online sales
Dotcorp	Adobe	Software company transitioned to online delivery

3. Classification of e-business according to dimensions

a. What do we mean by dimensions of commerce?

Answer:
Dimensions of commerce describe **how much of the transaction process is conducted electronically**, including product delivery, payment, and customer interaction.

b. Define traditional, pure, and partial e-commerce

- **Traditional commerce:** All activities are offline
- **Pure e-commerce:** Entire process is digital (product, payment, delivery)
- **Partial e-commerce:** Some elements are digital, others are physical or human-based

c. Examples of pure and partial e-commerce

Type	Example	Justification
Pure	PayPal	Digital service, digital delivery
Pure	Adobe Creative Cloud	Software delivered online
Partial	Dell	Online order, physical delivery
Partial	Barnes & Noble	Online browsing, physical books

d. “In the future all e-commerce will be pure e-commerce”

Answer:
This statement is unrealistic. While digital products may become fully electronic, many industries require physical goods, logistics, or human interaction. Therefore, partial e-commerce will continue to exist alongside pure e-commerce.

4. B2C and B2B e-commerce models

a. Classification by participants

Answer:
E-business can be classified based on who participates in the transaction.

b. Define B2C, B2B, B2G

- **B2C:** Business sells directly to consumers
- **B2B:** Business sells to other businesses
- **B2G:** Business provides services to government entities

c. Common B2C e-commerce models

Model	**Description**
E-tailer	Online retail stores
Service provider	Online services (e.g. PayPal)
Content provider	Digital content delivery
Portal	Information and service gateways

d. Important B2B e-commerce models

Model	**Description**
E-distributor	Online supply catalogues
E-procurement	Digital purchasing systems
Exchanges	B2B trading platforms

e. Classification of e-marketplaces

Criteria	Types
Industry areas	Vertical / Horizontal
Facilitators	Buyer-driven / Seller-driven / Neutral
Participants	One-to-many / Many-to-many

5. Categorisation of given e-commerce websites

Website	Participants	Business Model	Operation	Dimensions
barnesandnoble.com	B2C	E-tailer	Dotcorp	Partial
lycos.com	B2C	Portal	Dotcom	Pure
adobe.com	B2C/B2B	Service provider	Dotcorp	Pure
2000freebies.com	B2C	Portal	Dotcom	Pure
sba.gov	B2G	Government portal	Dotcorp	Pure
richmond.gov.uk/procurement	B2G	E-procurement	Dotcorp	Partial
dell.com	B2C/B2B	E-tailer	Dotcorp	Partial
fishingworld.com	B2C	E-tailer	Dotcorp	Partial
paypal.com	B2C/B2B	Service provider	Dotcom	Pure
tradekey.com	B2B	Marketplace	Dotcom	Pure

6. Categorisation of own online business idea (e-Coaching Platform)

Category	**Classification**
Participants	B2C & B2B
Business model	Marketplace
Form of operation	Dotcom
Dimensions	Partial e-commerce

Justification:
The e-Coaching platform facilitates online discovery, booking, and payment, while coaching is delivered through human interaction via digital channels.